

Office of the CFO

Outcome-Led Selling Playbook

A step-by-step field guide for running the 6-step Office of the CFO motion — with the exact prompt to run at each step. Designed to be followed manually, without invoking any automated skill.

How to use this playbook

This document reproduces the complete Office of the CFO Outcome Selling motion so an AE can run it manually. Work one step at a time. At each step: (1) gather the data, if required, (2) copy the "Prompt to run" into CoWork, replacing every [BRACKETED] field, (3) review the output against the operating rules, and (4) confirm the stopping point before advancing.

The motion leads with the customer business outcome, validates the Finance process and path to value, then applies the right solution play and team to deliver the technical and business win.

Kickoff (before Step 1)

Confirm these essentials before starting:

- Account(s) — the target(s), or a territory/account list to evaluate.
- Motion — Acquisition or Expansion.
- Entry point — start at Step 1, or jump to a specific step if you already have earlier outputs.

STEP 1

Identify Three Target Accounts

Objective: Identify an account to pursue and open a NEW conversation with the broader Finance organization (CFO, Controller, FP&A, Treasury, Tax, Internal Audit, Procurement, Investor Relations) — not the CFO alone.

Before prompting, decide which accounts you want to be considered.

- Score my whole book
- Filter to a top-N shortlist (default N ~ 10-15, ranked by Finance complexity/footprint) and score only those (preferred for larger book sizes)
- A specific segment/industry/region/list.

Prompt to run — Acquisition

Help me identify the best acquisition accounts for an Office of the CFO sales motion.

INPUT

Use my territory or account list (or provide a filtered list of accounts to review)

GOAL

Recommend three accounts where we can open a NEW conversation with the Finance organization (the Office of the CFO - CFO, Controller, FP&A, Treasury, Tax, Internal Audit, Procurement, or Investor Relations), and where a Finance leader could become an active business sponsor, not only a budget approver. Prioritize accounts where there is NOT already an active Finance / Office-of-the-CFO engagement - this is about breaking into Finance, not continuing a conversation already in flight.

EVALUATE EACH ACCOUNT FOR:

1. Finance mandate - margin, cash flow, cost reduction, forecasting, AI ROI, audit, regulatory, Finance transformation, operating efficiency, or unit-economics priorities.
2. Finance complexity - multi-entity/multinational ops, M&A, complex revenue, major CapEx, high transaction volume, treasury complexity, regulatory pressure, investor reporting.
3. Data and process friction - multiple ERP/EPM/BI/Finance systems; spreadsheet-dependent processes; manual reconciliation; fragmented data; AI initiatives without a data foundation.
4. Trigger events - new CFO/Finance leader, earnings pressure, restructuring, M&A, IPO readiness, major CapEx, AI announcements, regulatory change, ERP/Finance transformation.
5. Finance sponsor potential - is the outcome owned by a Finance leader, visible to board/investors, and does it need cross-functional sponsorship?
6. Open whitespace - confirm there is NO active Finance / Office-of-the-CFO engagement or in-flight Finance/renewal conversation today. An existing Data/IT or other-LOB relationship is acceptable as a warm path in, but not an active Finance conversation.
7. Working Office of the CFO play hypothesis - select one to validate (see Play List).

SCORE EACH ACCOUNT FROM 0 TO 100:

- Finance mandate urgency: 25
- Finance complexity: 20
- Data/process friction: 15
- Trigger and timing: 15
- Open whitespace: 10
- Play fit: 8
- Access path: 7

RETURN:

- Top three accounts and five backups
- Finance priority and supporting evidence
- Working Office of the CFO play hypothesis
- Preliminary value hypothesis
- Suggested first-meeting ask
- Score and reason to prioritize
- Confirmation no active Finance engagement
- Likely Finance owner, econ buyer, tech owner
- Metric to validate
- Recommended proof point
- Assumptions and confidence level

RULES

- Do not invent facts. Separate evidence from inference. Mark missing info "To validate."
- Do not select an account only because it is large, or only because there is an active CFO/renewal conversation - the goal is to OPEN a new Finance conversation.
- Target the broader Finance department, not the CFO alone.
- Do not make a final Office of the CFO play selection before discovery.

Prompt to run — Expansion

Help me identify the best existing Snowflake customers for an Office of the CFO expansion motion.

GOAL

Recommend three existing customers where we can open a NEW conversation with the Finance organization. Target accounts where Snowflake already has a footprint (typically Data/IT or another LOB) but Finance has NOT yet been engaged - use the existing relationship as a warm path into Finance. Prioritize accounts with NO active Finance / renewal conversation in flight.

INPUT

Use my territory or account list (or provide a filtered list of accounts to review)

LOOK FOR:

1. Finance intent - CFO, Controller, FP&A, Treasury, Tax, Internal Audit, Procurement, IR, Finance transformation, AI governance, forecasting, close, consolidation, margin, CapEx, cash.
2. Pain signals - manual/spreadsheet-heavy processes, fragmented data, slow reporting, data-quality issues, disconnected operational and financial data, or unclear AI value.
3. Open whitespace in Finance - footprint exists but Finance NOT yet engaged; confirm before scoring.
4. Access signals - existing Data/IT champions or other-LOB relationships; partners; prior VAs.
5. Relevant Snowflake footprint - ERP, CRM, product, revenue, billing, contract, procurement, cloud-spend, operational, profitability, AI, governance, or executive-reporting data.
6. Public urgency - margin pressure, cost programs, AI investments, Finance transformation, leadership change, M&A, regulatory pressure, new business models, or major CapEx.
7. Working Office of the CFO play hypothesis - select one to validate (see Play List).

SCORE EACH ACCOUNT FROM 0 TO 100:

- Finance-relevant footprint: 20
- Finance intent signals: 25
- Open whitespace: 15
- Warm path into Finance: 10
- Public trigger: 15
- Play fit: 8
- Expansion potential: 7

RETURN:

- Top three accounts and five backups
- Score and reason to prioritize now
- Specific Salesforce, engagement, and public evidence
- Confirmation Finance is not yet engaged
- Existing footprint and warm path into Finance
- Working play hypothesis
- Likely Finance buyer, technical owner, champion
- Preliminary value hypothesis and metric to validate
- Suggested meeting ask and proof point
- Recommended internal team
- Risks, assumptions, first action, confidence level

RULES

- Do not invent customer facts. Separate evidence from inference. Mark unverified "To validate."
- Prioritize accounts where I can take action this week.
- Do not select an account only because there is an active Finance/renewal conversation.
- Target the broader Finance department, not the CFO alone. No final play selection before discovery.

STOP: Explicitly choose exactly ONE account before running Step 2.

STEP 2

Build the Account Brief and Meeting Request

Objective: Consolidate research into one account-specific brief and a concise meeting-request email. Enter the meeting with a hypothesis, not a predetermined use case.

Prompt to run — Account Brief

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Create an account-specific Office of the CFO preparation brief for a Snowflake AE.

ACCOUNT: [ACCOUNT]
MOTION: [ACQUISITION OR EXPANSION]

USE AVAILABLE:
- Salesforce and engagement/Gong history          - Existing Snowflake workloads
- Earnings, annual reports, investor decks, press releases, CFO interviews
- Finance, AI, cost, M&A, restructuring, transformation announcements
- Approved Snowflake proof points and customer examples

PRODUCE:
1. Why this account, why now - three reasons; most important trigger; one-sentence AE POV.
2. The buyer - role, career history, priorities, prior transformation/vendor experience; likely scrutiny, risk concerns, accountability; evidence and unknowns.
3. Account history - relationships, champions, opportunities, competitive history, partners, executive access, unresolved concerns.
4. Finance mandate - top three priorities; evidence + metrics; most urgent; the priority Snowflake can most credibly address.
5. Preliminary value hypothesis - outcome; current-state pain hypothesis; metric to validate; likely value lever; assumptions requiring discovery.
6. Working Office of the CFO play hypothesis - one primary + one backup; outcome, pain signal, metric, process owner, required data, existing constraint, Snowflake fit, proof point.
7. Stakeholder map - economic buyer, CFO delegate, process owner, technical owner, champion, skeptic, executive sponsor, partner, missing contacts.
8. Meeting preparation - 20-second opening; seven account-specific discovery questions (why each matters and which play it supports/eliminates); one intended takeaway:
   "At the end of the meeting, we want the CFO to believe Snowflake can help [ACCOUNT] ____."
9. Meeting request - concise email referencing the company-specific priority, requesting a 30-minute Finance AI Readiness conversation, stating business purpose + expected output, and recommending the Finance and Data/IT attendees.

RULES: Do not invent facts. Separate evidence from inference. Mark missing info "To validate."
Use Office of the CFO language, not product language.
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Meeting-request email — Financial Services / GSIB (primary template)

For financial-services accounts, model the email on the canonical GSIB Office-of-the-CFO template. Adapt the segment label and pressure framing to the sub-industry (banking/GSIB, retail banking, capital markets, asset & wealth management, insurance, payments/fintech). Keep the four-part structure: pressure -> proof -> responsible use -> deployment.

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Generate a personalized meeting-request email for an Office of the CFO conversation.

ACCOUNT: [ACCOUNT]
MOTION: [ACQUISITION or EXPANSION]
RECIPIENT: [Name, title, and role of the Finance leader]
INDUSTRY: [Industry or sub-industry]

CONTEXT (from the account brief above):
- Company-specific trigger or priority: [e.g., earnings pressure, new CFO, AI announcement]
- Finance pain hypothesis: [e.g., manual close, stale forecasts, fragmented planning]
- Existing Snowflake relationship (if expansion): [e.g., data/IT workloads already on platform]
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- Known Finance personas or warm-path contacts: [if any]

GENERATE AN EMAIL THAT:

1. Opens with a short, specific meeting proposal (not a pitch) tied to the company's situation - reference the trigger/priority that makes this timely.
2. Establishes credibility - mention the pattern across peers (industry-appropriate: GSIBs, insurers, retailers, etc.) using agentic Finance workflows with strong results.
3. Proposes a responsible-use agenda: where not to use LLMs, cost optimization, security/governance, and how the workflows and guardrails were built.
4. Offers accelerated deployment options.
5. Closes with an offer to learn the recipient's priorities and align (not a hard sell).
6. If expansion: weave in one line referencing the data/workloads already on Snowflake as a natural bridge to Finance.

STYLE RULES:

- Short (80-140 words). No bullets or bold in the body. No flattery or buzzwords.
- Meeting-proposal framing, not a pitch. Get to the point immediately.
- Use language that would resonate with the CFO or finance department.
- Subject line: short, outcome-oriented, no clickbait.
- Do not invent customer facts. Mark any unverified claims "To validate."

RETURN: Subject line + email body. Ready to personalize and send.

STOP: Review the brief and email. You can also ask for first-meeting content or for a tailored Snowflake-branded deck.

STEP 3

Prepare for Likely Questions and Objections

Objective: Predict five likely business/Finance questions and five commercial/competitive/technical/implementation objections, and prepare a response, asset, owner, and validation for each.

Prompt to run

Prepare me for an Office of the CFO conversation with: [Account, Name, title, and role of the Finance leader]

USE: Office of the CFO account brief; Salesforce, engagement/Gong, MEDDPICC, competition, closed-lost history; current tech stack + Snowflake footprint; public company updates; preliminary value and Office of the CFO play hypotheses.

PREDICT:

- Five likely business or Finance questions specific to the persona and team we're targeting
- Five likely commercial, competitive, technical, or implementation objections

FOR EACH, PROVIDE: likely customer wording; why this account/exec may ask it; supporting evidence; concise response strategy; one follow-up discovery question; internal owner who should answer; required proof point/reference/document/diagram/demo; what must be validated; what not to say.

CONSIDER: ERP/EPM/BI/cloud/AI investments; coexistence and migration; ROI and total cost; time to first value; delivery ownership and partners; references; consumption and renewal; AI accuracy and human review; governance and auditability; Finance adoption.

RETURN A TABLE:

Finance Question	Why It Matters	Response	Asset	Owner	Validation
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RULES: Make every question account-specific. Do not invent claims or customer positions. Mark weak predictions "Possible, needs validation." Recommend only assets that directly answer a likely question.

STOP: Review the table of recommended questions and objections. Prompt for additional insight, if needed.

STEP 4

Run Office of the CFO Discovery

Objective: Host a discovery session and leave with: a Finance-owned outcome, current process + baseline, business impact, Finance owner + economic buyer, data/system path, urgency, governance requirements, and a calendarized next step.

30-minute example agenda

Time	Focus	Output
0-3	Confirm relevance and agenda	Permission to run discovery
3-8	Finance mandate & ideal success	Agreed outcome area
8-20	Process, friction, metrics, and data	Pain, owner, baseline, constraints
20-25	Play back findings	Confirmed problem statement
25-30	Agree next step	Calendarized action

Opening (say this)

"To make this useful, I would like to understand which Finance outcome you are being asked to improve, how the process works today, and what is making it difficult. We can then determine whether there is one focused area worth examining further."

Discovery question bank — select 5-7 for the account

Forecasting & Planning

- When the business changes mid-quarter, how quickly can FP&A produce a trusted reforecast?
- Which operational signals reach the forecast too late?
- Which parts of planning still rely on extracts, spreadsheets, or manual uploads?
- Can you compare prior scenario assumptions with what actually occurred?

Close & Consolidation

- Where does the close depend on manual data gathering, reconciliation, or commentary?
- How much time is spent reconciling data versus analyzing results?
- How do local entities and group Finance access the right level of detail from the same model?

AI Spend & Governance

- How is AI spend measured today: by team, model, workload, use case, or outcome?
- Who is accountable for AI spend and value?
- What control and human-review requirements must be met before Finance trusts an AI-assisted workflow?

Unit Economics

- Can Finance see profitability by customer, product, channel, or deal early enough to influence decisions?
- Where do Finance and commercial teams use different assumptions?
- Which decisions would change with more current unit economics?

CapEx & Project Finance

- Can Finance see project spend, completion risk, financing, cash flow, and P&L impact together?
- When a project slips, how quickly can you assess impact on EBITDA, liquidity, leverage, and covenants?
- How much of the project-finance view is assembled manually?

Earnings, Audit & Reporting

- How much earnings or board-preparation time is spent gathering and validating numbers?
- Where is commentary manually assembled?
- Where does Internal Audit still rely on manual sampling and evidence collection?
- Which controls would be most valuable to monitor continuously?

Data & Systems

- Which Finance decisions require data from CRM, product usage, contracts, cloud billing, or operations?
- Where do teams create their own version of the number?
- Which ERP, EPM, planning, or BI capabilities must remain?

Snowflake-on-Snowflake bridges (operating examples, NOT guaranteed outcomes)

- Quarterly earnings reporting moved from ~two weeks to 48 hours.
- Long-range planning moved from 50+ spreadsheets and three people to one analyst using Streamlit.
- Revenue can be reforecast daily using current business signals.
- AI-generated earnings commentary supports C-Suite and IR preparation.
- Account-level unit economics support Finance, Deal Desk, Alliances, and Engineering.

Discovery summary — play-back template

"The priority is [outcome]. Today, the process takes [baseline] and is constrained by [pain]. [Owner] is accountable, the impact is [business consequence], and the required data comes from [systems]. This matters now because [trigger]. Is that accurate?"

Exit criteria — do not advance without

a Finance-owned outcome - a metric or plan to establish one - a meaningful problem - a Finance process owner - a likely economic buyer - an understood data path - a reason to act - a calendarized next step.

STOP: Once you have completed discovery and have a finance-owned outcome you can select a primary play and continue with the next step.

STEP 5

Select One Office of the CFO Play

Objective: Only after discovery, select ONE primary play. Score ALL financial use cases (the three priority use cases — Long Range Plan Forecasting, Financial Close Analyses, SEC Disclosures & Earnings Prep — plus all secondary plays) and select the one that best matches the discovered pain. A secondary use case is equally valid when it fits better.

Play Guide

Customer Evidence	Play	Likely Owner	Metric
Slow or stale forecasts	Continuous forecasting	VP FP&A	Speed and accuracy
Spreadsheet-based scenarios	Scenario planning	Strategic Finance	Scenario cycle time
Manual close, flux, or reconciliation	Close automation	Controller	Close days and effort
Multiple entities and ERPs	Group consolidation	Group Finance	Consolidation cycle
Unclear AI spend and value	AI cost governance	CFO or AI owner	Cost by outcome
Fragmented major-project visibility	CapEx and project finance	CFO or Treasury	Budget, delay, leverage
Manual earnings preparation	Earnings and IR	FP&A or IR	Preparation time
Spend leakage or exceptions	T&E and spend	Controller or Procurement	Leakage and exceptions
Fragmented liquidity data	Treasury	Treasurer	Cash latency and accuracy
Manual tax or regulatory reporting	Tax and regulatory	VP Tax	Filing effort and exceptions
Disconnected financial and ESG data	ESG reporting	CFO or ESG Finance	Reconciliation and reporting
Manual control testing	Continuous controls	Internal Audit	Hours and coverage

Prompt to run — Discovery-to-Play

Analyze the Office of the CFO discovery notes for: [ACCOUNT]

INPUTS: Office of the CFO account brief; discovery notes or Gong transcript.

SUMMARIZE: outcome, process, baseline, impact, owner, buyer, data, urgency, maturity, governance, missing information.

SCORE EACH RELEVANT PLAY FROM 0 TO 2 ON:

- Outcome alignment
- Confirmed pain
- Metric clarity
- Owner strength
- Data availability
- Urgency
- Feasible validation path

Score ALL Office of the CFO use cases (Long Range Plan Forecasting, Financial Close Analyses, SEC Disclosures & Earnings Prep, plus T&E/Spend, AI Cost Governance, Unit use case based on best fit to the discovered pain - state why it was selected.

RETURN:

- One primary Office of the CFO play
- Evidence for the selection
- Metric and value lever
- Remaining questions
- One backup only if strongly supported
- Why other plays were not selected
- Required stakeholders and data
- Recommended next step

SELECT ONE READINESS STATUS:

- Ready for Finance AI Readiness Workshop
- Ready for technical discovery
- No qualified Office of the CFO play
- Ready for Value Assessment
- More business discovery required

RULES: Do not invent missing information. Do not select a play without a Finance-owned outcome and Finance owner. Do not recommend several equal priorities.

STOP: Review and utilize the output. In preparation for an executive-level meeting (step 6), it will require you to typically have a number of meetings with the prospect/customer, refine your value hypothesis, and truly qualify the use case. These steps cannot happen back to back.

STEP 6

Select the Team and Prepare the Executive Meeting

Objective: Produce the Executive Meeting Readiness Pack and identify teams who may be able to support.

Team Selection Guide

Team	Engage When	Contribution
Value Advisory	Value hypothesis & narrative, Business case / funding justification must be quantified	Value hypothesis , value framework, ROI analysis, cost of inaction
Forward Deployed Engineering	Customer wants to build out a custom AI Finance solution on Snowflake	Feasibility, design, data requirements, prototype path
Industry Specialist	Industry economics, regulation, or credibility matters	Industry POV, metrics, peer patterns, risks
Services Delivery	Solution direction understood; implementation support needed	Scope, phases, resources, dependencies, timeline
Partner	ERP/EPM integration, redesign, delivery capacity, or exec access	Integration, transformation, implementation, access
Customer Enablement	Adoption requires training, new workflows, or broad rollout	User readiness, enablement, rollout, success measures

Prompt to run — Executive Meeting Readiness

Create a readiness pack for this Office of the CFO meeting.

ACCOUNT: [ACCOUNT]

DATE AND MEETING TYPE: [DATE, DISCOVERY, WORKSHOP, VALUE REVIEW, DEMO, ETC.]

INPUTS: Office of the CFO brief; discovery notes; selected play; preliminary value hypothesis; customer and Snowflake attendees; approved references and proof points.

PRODUCE:

1. Why this account, why now
2. Buyer priorities, likely scrutiny, and credibility risks
3. One objective: "At the end of the meeting, we want the CFO to believe Snowflake can help [ACCOUNT] ____."
4. Top five Office of the CFO questions, response strategy, owner, asset, validation required
5. Account-specific demo guidance - customer terminology, entities, projects, currency, metrics, users, scenarios, outputs, key message, and what not to show
6. Commercial and implementation readiness - indicative cost, time to value, scope, coexistence/migration, delivery owner, partners, references, consumption questions, 90-/180-day plan
7. Role assignments - why each person attends, what they answer, own, and must validate
8. Timed agenda
9. Readiness checklist with: Ready / Owner assigned / Blocking the meeting

RULES: Do not invent product, commercial, partner, or reference claims. Recommend one compelling demonstration per topic. Use the customer's terminology and metrics. Keep the meeting focused on one takeaway.

STOP: Review the readiness pack and engage your prospect/customer. Prompt for additional insight, if needed.